

# Production Cost Analysis & Replication Guide: Cyberpunk AI Music Video

## Executive Summary

While a traditional live-action shoot with high-end sci-fi costumes, concert lighting, and post-production visual effects would cost between **\$18,000 and \$35,000**, this specific clip was generated using **Generative AI** for approximately **\$30 to \$150 in tool subscriptions and API credits**. Because the source video uses Google's generative media technologies (including Google Veo and custom text-to-video tools), you can replicate this exact aesthetic using consumer-accessible AI tools today for a tiny fraction of a traditional production budget.

## Cost Comparison: Traditional vs. AI Production

| Cost Category              | Traditional Live-Action Production                                 | Generative AI Workflow                            |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Stage & Studio Rental      | \$3,000 – \$6,000 (Stage with concert trussing & smoke machines)   | \$0 (Virtual environment)                         |
| Costumes, Props & Wardrobe | \$2,500 – \$5,000 (Custom cyberpunk armor, LED respirator masks)   | \$0 – \$10 (Midjourney / Flux prompt tokens)      |
| Crew & Equipment           | \$5,000 – \$10,000 (Director, DP, Gaffer, Camera packages, Lenses) | \$0 (Self-directed / AI rendering)                |
| Talent & Extras            | \$2,000 – \$4,000 (Lead singer, keyboardist, guitarist, bassist)   | \$0 (AI-generated visual avatars)                 |
| Audio Production & Vocals  | \$1,500 – \$3,500 (Studio recording, session singer, mixing)       | \$10 – \$30 (Suno v4 / Udio J-Rock generator)     |
| Post-Production & VFX      | \$4,000 – \$8,000 (HUD graphics, color grading, edit)              | \$10 – \$30 (Editing software + AI video credits) |
| TOTAL ESTIMATE             | <b>\$18,000 – \$36,500</b>                                         | <b>\$50 – \$150</b>                               |

## Option 1: The AI Replication Workflow (Under \$100)

To recreate or "copy" this video's style using modern AI tools, follow this step-by-step pipeline:

### Step 1: Audio Generation (\$10 – \$20)

- **Tool:** Suno AI v4 or Udio
- **Prompt Strategy:** "Cyberpunk J-Rock, female lead vocals with gas mask pitch shift, heavy synth bass, high-tempo electric guitar, futuristic electronic metal, concert energy"

- **Output:** Generates a 2 to 3 minute full track with singing, instruments, and rhythm.

## Step 2: Character & Shot Concepting (\$10 – \$20)

- **Tool:** Midjourney v6 or Flux Pro
- **Prompt Strategy:** *"Cinematic front shot of a female cyberpunk lead singer wearing a sleek black armored suit and illuminated futuristic respirator mask holding a vintage microphone, onstage neon pink and purple concert lights, smoke effects, band members playing in background, highly detailed photorealistic 8k --ar 16:9"*

## Step 3: Video Animation & Lipsync (\$30 – \$60)

- **Tool:** Google Veo, Runway Gen-3 Alpha, Luma Dream Machine, or Kling AI
- **Process:** Use **Image-to-Video** mode. Upload your generated base image, feed in the audio segment, and prompt for movement: *"Slow camera dolly forward, female singer moving rhythmically with microphone, bright stage lights flashing in background, smoke moving smoothly"*

## Step 4: UI Graphics & HUD Overlays (\$0 – \$20)

- **Tool:** CapCut Pro or Adobe Premiere Pro
- **Process:** Add sci-fi subtitle overlays with faux Japanese/English cyberpunk characters, lens flares, and digital noise filters.

## Option 2: Traditional Live-Action Production Breakdown (\$18,000+)

If a production studio were to film this clip physically, the budget breaks down as follows:

1. **Pre-Production (\$2,500):** Storyboarding, costume design, lighting design, casting band members.
2. **Venue & Rigging (\$4,500):** Renting a soundstage equipped with lighting trusses, moving spotlight heads, fog/haze machinery, and Marshall speaker stacks.
3. **Wardrobe & SFX (\$3,500):** 3D printing or custom molding sci-fi armor suits, wiring functioning LED visor goggles and respirator gas masks.
4. **Production Day (\$8,000):** 10-hour shoot day including Director of Photography, Gaffer, Key Grip, Audio Tech, Hair/Makeup artist, and 4 actors/musicians.
5. **Post-Production (\$6,000):** Color grading, dynamic HUD overlay graphics, motion tracking for floating UI text, and audio mastering.

## Summary & Recommendation

If your goal is to produce music videos or visual content in this style:

- **Recommendation: Use the AI workflow.** A complete 2-minute video can be generated in 1–2 days for under \$100 using subscriptions to tools like Google Veo/Runway and Suno/Udio.
- **Key Challenge in AI:** Achieving precise lip-syncing and consistent character faces

across multiple camera cuts requires fine-tuning and multiple generation attempts, but it remains dramatically cheaper than traditional film shoots.